

Metadata Reliance in Vision-Language Models for CT Lung Nodule Malignancy Prediction

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Data sharing statement: All data and code supporting this study are publicly available. Per-sample VLM and DL predictions, cross-family audit outputs, the LNDb external-validation CSV, the Brock prediction file, prompts, exemplar identifiers, and all analysis code are available at <https://github.com/mengxinlab/VLMvsDL> under the Apache 2.0 license. LUNA25 is available at <https://luna25.grand-challenge.org/>; LNDb labels derive from the public LNDb cohort. Raw CT data are not redistributed and should be obtained from LUNA25 and LNDb under their respective terms. (This statement and the repository link are withheld from the blinded manuscript for double-blind review.)